Collaborative Document RSS day 5

2026-09-15-research-software-support-training

Welcome to The Workshop Collaborative Document.

This Document is synchronized as you type, so that everyone viewing this page sees the same text. This allows you to collaborate seamlessly on documents.

This is the Document for today: https://edu.nl/6jm6x

Collaborative Document day 1: https://edu.nl/nmwaj

Collaborative Document day 2: https://edu.nl/jnqpv

Collaborative Document day 3: https://edu.nl/g6eqm

Collaborative Document day 4: https://edu.nl/mwc48

Collaborative Document day 5: https://edu.nl/6jm6x

Code of Conduct

Participants are expected to follow these guidelines:

- Use welcoming and inclusive language.
- Be respectful of different viewpoints and experiences.
- Gracefully accept constructive criticism.
- Focus on what is best for the community.
- Show courtesy and respect towards other community members.

If you feel that the code of conduct is breached, please talk to one of the instructors (if the complaint is for one of the participants) or send an email to training@esciencecenter.nl (if the complaint is for one of the instructors).

Certificate of attendance

If you attend the full workshop we will send you a certificate of attendance.
We will delete all personal identifyable information 8 months after the training.

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Getting help

To ask a question, raise your hand in zoom. Click on the icon labeled "Reactions" in the toolbar on the bottom center of your screen,
then click the button 'Raise Hand '. For urgent questions, just unmute and speak up!

You can also ask questions or type 'I need help' in the chat window and helpers will try to help you.
Please note it is not necessary to monitor the chat - the helpers will make sure that relevant questions are addressed in a plenary way.
(By the way, off-topic questions will still be answered in the chat)

Workshop website & Lesson materials

RSST Sept-Oct 2026 (https://esciencecenter-digital-skills.github.io/2026-09-15-ds-rss-masterclass/)

RSST lesson material (https://esciencecenter-digital-skills.github.io/research-software-support/)

Instructors

Eva Lekkerkerker, Ole Mussmann

Helpers

Fenne Riemslagh, Faruk Diblen, Carlos Martinez

Agenda

Time	Topic
09:00	Welcome and recap
09:15	Gen AI Lesson Pilot
10:15	Break
10:30	Gen AI Lesson Pilot
11:45	Break
12:00	Workshop Recap & Questions
13:00	End of day 5

Questions from last week

Q: I often use the terms library and package interchangeably, what would you say is the difference?
A: A package can contain libraries, and the library is usually packaged into the software package. The terms are often used interchangeably. Packaging is a technique for collections of software: libraries are quite often the packages that people will use, but it might also contain a software.

Q: How is the RSD different from Software Heritage?
A:

- Software Heritage is only for the *source code* of software, while Zenodo is also for *data, posters, slides and other artefacts*.
- Software Heritage is about *all* software, while Zenodo is about *open science*.
- Software Heritage only archives the source code, while Zenodo also allows citation, has communities, has more extensive search features.

Have a look at the about page of Zenodo (https://about.zenodo.org/) and the mission statement of Software Heritage (https://www.softwareheritage.org/mission/). Since recently, Zenodo and Software Heritage integrate with each other (https://blog.zenodo.org/2024/10/21/2024-10-21-swh/).

Q: Why would you choose for Zenodo, comparative to other options like 4TU.ResearchData, where you also get a DOI.
A: Zenodo is for archiving long-term. 4TU seems more like a GitHub alternative. It doesn't give the scientific context of the software, where the RSD harvests that information on a landing page for your software.

Q: Does GitLab have Zenodo integration just like GitHub has?
A: No, this, this feature request from 2018 (https://github.com/zenodo/zenodo-rdm/issues/1203) is still open. Have a look at this unofficial script (https://gitlab.com/deploy2zenodo/deploy2zenodo).

Q: If I edit the MATLAB Toolbox enough, can I contribute my changes or license my changes?
A: If it's a library in MATLAB Toolbox, then that library might have a separate license that allows modification. That is something you will have to check. If a separate license doesn't exist, MATLAB restricts you. MATLAB has file-exchange where people can make Toolboxes and publish them. MATLAB automatically assign DSB open license, but you can probably also choose a different open source license.

Q: What about software that you create outside op work hours.
A: If you make software outside of workhours on your worklaptop, ownership can be claimed for work. If you make software intended for work related activities on your personal laptop, that can also be regarded as owned by your employer.

Q: If someone uses AI to rewrite your software under GPL?
A: it's unclear what judicial outcomes will be of copyright cases that are inspected right now. It's a grey area how a derivative work falls under software copyright. You do need copyright permission to train model on data - also being litigated right now. If the structure and story of the code is roughly the same it's still copyright infringement.

Q: in what category falls the creative common license? and what is the difference between CC and these licenses?
A: The licenses listed are software licenses - they are older than the Creative Commons licenses. CC were inspired by these licenses. Not all are akin to open source - like no-derivative licenses. The GPL makes a clear distinction between source code and library - but CC' licenses do not use such distinction. Software licenses offer more specificity. If you publish software - use a specific software license. If you publish your presentation about the software, or a blog you wrote, or learning materials - use Creative Commons.

Q: Maybe too specific but: How does this work with dual licensing? If I remember correctly I have seen things from eScience center both under a GPL and apache license simultaniously
A: Dual licensing can happen if you have software that has multiple sources. If you have your pyramid of libraries under your script/notebook, you have to follow the licenses of all those libraries. If the licenses are different it is still possible to distribute the whole pyramid, but you need to adhere to all those licenses simultaneously, and use the right license for the appropriate brick of code. Some licenses are more compatible than others - like GPL & MIT. If

you have proprietary licenses then it may become a problem - perhaps the proprietary license doesn't allow sharing source code, while GPL forces you to share source code. That becomes an issue.

Q: We often share mainly data, but also with developed software within that same collection. And then the data considerations usually prevail. What are your thoughts on this?
A: If your software is under a Creative Commons license, it depends which one it is. It will be difficult to combine that software with other software under an open source license. If it's a non-derivative CC license that is not compatible with open source. If its CC-0 that is basically compatible with open source software licenses. If the software is a finished application to work with that data - then maybe its not an issue in practice. Still recommend to split it off - and use a separate license for open source software license.

Q: What if you (want to) change and/or add a license at a later date? Can you do that and does it apply retroactively?
A: Yes, you can change a license. But you cannot withdraw an open source license. If people downloaded it under an open source license, you cannot retroactively restrict those users access to the software. Once someone has that license, they get to keep it. If you want to change the license, you need permission from all the copyright owners. If you're the main person - that's not so difficult. But if it's Linux for example - they have thousands of copyright holders - you would require permission from everyone. Typically it's resolved by making a new release, and older releases would remain under their old license. Sometimes copyright holders are not available to reach - you would have to redevelop their parts of the software.

Collaborative Notes

Gen AI Pilot

Notes.

Excercises

1. AI Battle

2. Client Settings

3. AI Declaration

Questions This Week

Q: How to avoid using GenAI in Google Search Machine?
A: Add -AI to the start of your search in google

Q: are our goals for achieving FAIR data & software in part supporting AI development because of the machine-readability capabilities we work towards? e.g. couldn’t AI agents meet the lofty end-goals of fully functional FAIR systems that allow a program to run around finding all the necessary data a researcher needs, check permissions, run analyses and provide results without the researchers active involvement?

A: Ideally, yes! Machine actionability has been a part of the vision of how FAIR could help accelerate research. There is still room for improvement in this direction, in terms of better meta-data annotation (both for data and software).

Q: have our efforts towards FAIR made things easier for big AI companies to utilize our work and data in ways we didn’t intend/want? e.g. does our FAIR work end up helping LLMs
A: Probably, yes. Of course we don't know, because nobody know how big AI companies are training their models. But of course data being nicely structured and documented makes it easier for others -- including AI companies -- to use.

Q: what do you think about the new "trend" of using claude to re-create proprietary software like Adobe and making an open-source free version of the same? E.g. PhotoCraft as open-source version of Photoshop?
A: When it comes to making a derivative, some copyright and licensing issues can arise that the developer has to take into account. Having more free versions of proprietary software, and the relative "ease" in which they are produced, puts pressure on commercial organisations to justify their licensing pricing schemes.

:book: Homework

- Prompt Engineering: https://esciencecenter-digital-skills.github.io/research-software-support/modules/gen-ai/prompt-engineering
- GenAI Training Resources: https://esciencecenter-digital-skills.github.io/research-software-support/modules/gen-ai/resources

Resources

- Open call for Carpentries Instructors: https://community.data.4tu.nl/open-call-individual-applications-for-carpentries-instructor-training-seats/
- Coding cafes https://code-cafes-nl.github.io/cafe_playbook/
- List of events from Eva: https://researchsoftwaretraining.nl/%F0%9F%8D%82fall-training-events/
- RST-NL meet-up 19 November (Open Source Alternatives & HPC+AI Carpentries Developments): https://researchsoftwaretraining.nl/november-19-open-source-software-alternatives-carpentries-curriculum-developments-hpc-ai-networking-drinks/
- Data Horror Week (26/29 October) https://bibliotheek.hu.nl/onderzoekers/DHW/
- AI Declaration Tool: https://ai-declaration.org/
- RSE Agent Skills: https://rseng-skills.com/
    - Subagents (mentor, reviewer, librarian, compliance checker): https://rseng-skills.com/#/agents
- Netherlands eScience Center. (2026). The Netherlands eScience Center Generative AI Use Policy. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23209556
- NWO Policy on GenAI : https://www.nwo.nl/en/nwo-policy-on-the-use-of-generative-ai
- Coding with AI training: https://southampton-rsg-training.github.io/coding-with-ai/2-ai-assisted-coding.html